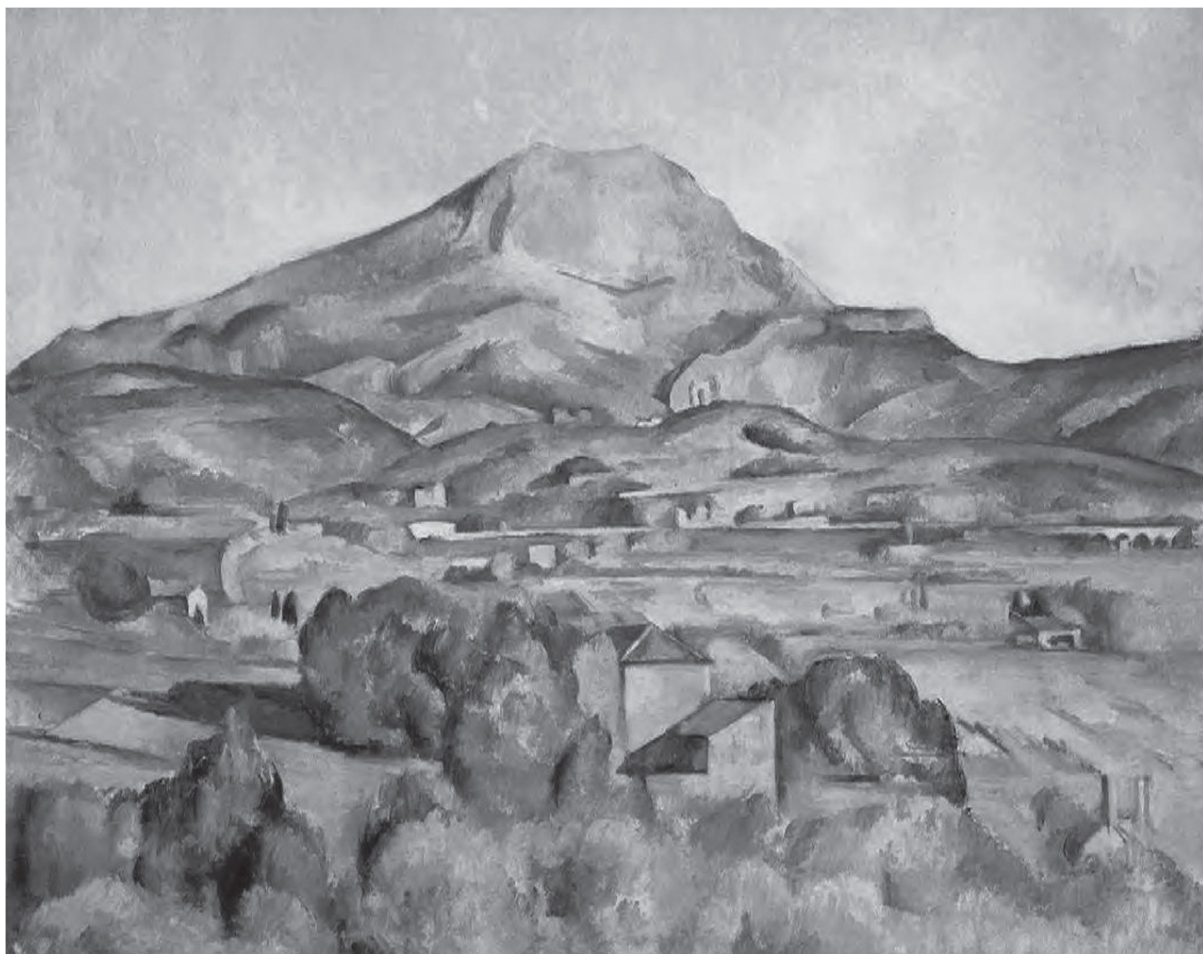


Cézanne

One of the single most influential artists in the shaping of 20th-century art, Paul Cézanne (1839–1906) aimed to find a pictorial form that he believed would make sense of the world. In doing so, he changed the history of art. Both Matisse and Picasso called him ‘the father of us all’.

For most of his life, Cézanne was misunderstood and his art ridiculed. Every year from 1864 to 1869, he submitted work to the Paris Salon, but was constantly rejected. Then he befriended the Impressionists and exhibited with them in 1874 and 1877, but although he went on painting expeditions with Pissarro, and for a while described himself as Pissarro’s pupil, he was a solitary man, and soon moved back to his family home in Provence. There, he tried to work out his own methods by representing a sense of the structure of things, painting shapes and blocks of colour to show underlying forms. He evolved a technique of applying angled patches of paint using a restricted palette, and moved away from the single viewpoint that most artists traditionally depict.



Cézanne, *Mont Sainte-Victoire*, 1885–95